



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

iti buddhir* iyaṃ* ca nīrajaskā |
vavṛdhe tasya mahā+ātmano* viśuddhā |
puruṣair* a+parair* a+dṛśyamānaḥ |
puruṣaś* ca*upasasarpa bhikṣu+(veśaḥ Cveśaḥ) | |5.16|
nara+deva+sutas* tam abhyapṛcchad* |
vada ko* *asi*iti śaśaṃsa so* *atha tasmai |
(nara+puṃ+Csa* ca puṃ+)gava janma+mṛtyu+bhītaḥ |
śramaṇaḥ pravrajito* *asmi mokṣa+hetoḥ | |5.17|

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 5, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This isn't just intellectual understanding; it's a deep, purified wisdom accessible to all of us when we quiet the noise of our daily lives. The verse speaks of him being unseen by ordinary men, highlighting the internal and deeply personal nature of this awakening. Then, a mendicant appears, representing the path of renunciation and spiritual seeking.

The encounter between Siddhartha and the mendicant is pivotal. Siddhartha, the prince destined for worldly power, inquires about the stranger's identity. The mendicant's response is simple yet profound: he is a renunciate, a seeker of liberation from the cycle of birth and death, driven by fear of suffering, striving for moksha. This is the essence of the spiritual path - acknowledging our shared human condition of suffering and actively seeking a way out. The mendicant's words cut through the illusion of worldly happiness, exposing the underlying anxiety that drives much of our behavior.

This passage holds immense relevance for your own life. Are you courageous enough to acknowledge your own suffering, your own fear of mortality? Do you dare to question the values and goals that society often imposes upon you, the relentless pursuit of wealth, status, and fleeting pleasures? The mendicant's journey, driven by a desire to escape suffering, is a mirror reflecting your own potential for spiritual growth. It prompts you to examine your attachments and consider what truly matters in the grand scheme of things. Just as Siddhartha was moved by this encounter, you too can use it as a catalyst for your own inward journey. It is about recognizing that true freedom lies not in external achievements but in inner liberation.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What fears are subconsciously dictating your choices, and what small step can you take today to move toward liberation?